THE BURGESS PERSIAN LETTERS

Edited by BENJAMIN SCHWARTZ

PART II

[HENRY BURGESS TO CHARLES BURGESS] *Hempstead, October 18, 1830*

Mr. Hanson gave me yesterday a deplorable account of the condition of the East whither you and my dear Edward are bending your steps. He says that the Plague is raging at Trebizonde and other places: — that the Cholera morbus has not yet spent its ravages: — that trade is very bad in Persia, and that the Persians will buy nothing at Constantinople. But, he anticipated, that in a few months the diseases would disappear and trade revive. Not that the trade was affected by the diseases alone — there being a great glut of goods generally. But he said that nobody hardly is now shipping, instead of every-body, and that he had himself just now been buying Manchester goods, to send out, because he obtained them at a reduction of five per cent; which is a plain proof that he calculated on a speedy revival of business at Constantinople.

I have paid the insurance on your goods amounting to £53.17.6. Messrs. Hanson will write out to Mr. C. Hanson tomorrow to advance, if necessary, 200£, I having engaged by a letter written to them, according to their desire, to honour any bill drawn by you in that gentleman's favour not exceeding that am^{t}. In drawing any bill, if you have a necessity for drawing one, you must be careful to draw it at three months after *sight;* — four months would be better than three.

* * *

I wrote to you from LPool in my way out to Ebro. The part of that letter written on the Rail-way[9] is a great curiosity. Any distinguished Englishman would consider it such. You cannot imagine what interest another specimen which I wrote at the same time has excited.

[CHARLES BURGESS TO HENRY BURGESS] *Constantinople, December 9, 1830*

I wrote you a hasty line by the courier, which went off immediately after our arrival. I hope you would get it safe, as from the length of our passage no doubt you would be somewhat anxious. We start on the 11th on board an Austrian ship for Trebizonde, having decided upon that route for various reasons, which I will now state. 1st. It is much the cheapest and the quickest. 2nd there was no

[9] The Liverpool and Manchester Railway was formally opened to the public on Sept. 15, 1830, just about one month before the date of this letter. While the Stockton and Darlington Railway, completed in 1825, had demonstrated the practicability of the steam locomotive on its tracks, the Liverpool and Manchester was the first railroad designed and built for the use of steam locomotion. Ebro, of course, stands for Edinburgh.

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